



The New Mexico DarkSky Ancestral Sky Ally Program

Become an Ancestral Skies Ally by showing that your business realizes the benefits of natural night skies.

WHAT IS THE PROGRAM??

The NM DarkSky Ancestral Skies Ally program is a New Mexico-based public recognition program supporting businesses that adopt lighting practices that reduce light pollution and protect dark skies. It is sponsored by New Mexico DarkSky, a chapter of DarkSky International.

The goal of the program is to recognize businesses that have demonstrated appreciation and implementation of the five principles of responsible lighting. Qualified businesses do not need to be located in locations with dark skies, but they do need to have lighting that does not add to light pollution.

WHY IS RESPONSIBLE LIGHTING IMPORTANT?

Light pollution has negative effects on human and environmental health, public safety, the nocturnal environment, historic districts, and our cultural heritage. New Mexico is fortunate to have many locations with dark skies, and these are increasingly important for drawing visitors to our state!

WHAT'S IN IT FOR MY BUSINESS AND MY COMMUNITY?

Being an Ancestral Skies Ally distinguishes your business as a responsible member of the community, thereby attracting customers and building loyalty. Preserving New Mexico's ancestral skies encourages dark sky tourism that generates higher local spending and creates jobs. Responsible outdoor lighting reduces electrical usage and saves money. Responsible lighting can also increase safety and security.

HOW DOES MY BUSINESS QUALIFY AS NEW MEXICO NIGHT SKY FRIENDLY?

Lights at qualified businesses will adhere to the five principles of responsible lighting:

1. Use light only if it is needed
2. Direct light so it falls only where it is needed
3. Light should be no brighter than necessary
4. Use light only when it is needed.
5. Use warmer colored lights when it is possible

Businesses will achieve certification by completing a [spreadsheet \(see example\)](#) that lists each of your outdoor lights and provides a checklist to determine if they adhere to the five principles. Your submitted spreadsheet will include photos of each light fixture. Special considerations can be submitted. The completed spreadsheet will then be reviewed by New Mexico DarkSky and certification will be granted if the principles have been followed! If your business has a large number of individual compliant lights, making completion of the spreadsheet impractical, consult with us to determine if we can find an efficient way to grant the certification.

For more information on the five principles and how to apply them, see [DarkSky International's page on responsible lighting](#).

NM DarkSky will follow up on a 1-3 year cycle for you to confirm that your business continues to comply with the principles.

HOW DO I START?

Email newmexico@darksky.org to request an application spreadsheet for your specific business. We can provide a link to a Google spreadsheet or send an Excel spreadsheet for you to complete and submit.

A nominal application fee is required to cover chapter expenses for the program, you can choose from:

- \$10 Application Fee: Non-refundable fee to ONLY get the static cling window sticker and a paper certificate
- \$25 Application Fee: Non-refundable fee to get a framed certificate and static cling window sticker
- \$50 Application Fee: Non-refundable fee to get a metal sign and static cling window sticker

The fee will be paid to the NM chapter through a [DarkSky International link](#)

IF MY BUSINESS QUALIFIES, WHAT DO I GET?

You will receive a [window cling](#) to announce to customers your certification as a Dark Sky Friendly business, and, for an increased application fee, a framed or metal [Ancestral Skies Ally Award Certificate](#) appropriate for display inside your business. You will have the right to use the Dark Sky Friendly Business logo in your business advertising and communications.

We will also [list your business](#) on the New Mexico DarkSky website nmdarksky.org as an Ancestral Skies Ally and Dark Sky Friendly Business.

WHAT ELSE DO I NEED TO KNOW?

By accepting the Ancestral Skies Ally Award Certificate, your business or organization agrees to the following:

- You agree to maintain your lighting in the same (or better) condition as stated on your application. If you do not, you agree to remove all certificates from display.
- Any future outdoor lighting installed or activated on your premises will be Dark Sky Friendly by following the five principles of responsible outdoor lighting.
- Agree to respond to inquiries from NM DarkSky if any questions come up about the qualification of your lighting

For More Information: newmexico@darksky.org, nmdarksky.org

